

Word family: **reaction / reactions / react / reacted / reacting / reactive / reactivity**

Base word: reaction

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **reaction** (n.) — 反應；回應；反作用；化學反應

* **react** (v.) — 作出反應；回應；起反應

* **reactive** (adj.) — 反應性的；被動回應的；化學上活潑的

* **reactivity** (n.) — 反應性；活性

* **reactionary** (adj./n.) — 反動的；反動派（政治 / 歷史語境，屬另一較專門分支，不建議和一般 reaction 混在一起學）

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **reaction to**

* **have a reaction**

* **get a reaction**

* **immediate reaction**

* **strong reaction**

* **emotional reaction**

* **public reaction**

* **market reaction**

* **allergic reaction**

* **chemical reaction**

* **chain reaction**

* **reaction time**

* **react to**

* **react badly / strongly**

* **overreact**

* **underreact**

* **reactive substance**

* **reactive approach**

Meaning in this passage

> That **reaction** told me I had hit the nail on the head.

Here, **reaction** means:

the way someone responds emotionally or behaviourally to something that happens — 反應；回應

The mother laughed at some pages, became quiet at others, and got emotional. Those responses showed the speaker that the gift had affected her in exactly the hoped-for way.

****中文翻譯：****

她的這些****反應****讓我知道，這份禮物真的送對了。

So here:

****reaction = 某人面對事情後表現出來的情緒、說話或行為回應****

1. ****reaction (反應；回應) — 反應****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Her ****reaction**** told me I had chosen the right gift.

她的****反應****讓我知道自己選對了禮物。

Practice 2

> His ****reaction**** surprised everyone.

他的****反應****令所有人都很驚訝。

Practice 3

> I watched her face to see her ****reaction****.

我看着她的表情，想看看她有甚麼****反應****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reaction = 某人在某件事發生後所表現出的情緒、行為或言語回應****

2. ****reaction to something — 對.....的反應****

Practice 1

> What was her ****reaction to the gift****?

她對這份禮物有甚麼**反應**？

Practice 2

> His **reaction to the news** was surprisingly calm.

他對這個消息的**反應**出奇地平靜。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****reaction to X = 某人因 X 而產生的情緒、行為或言語回應****

3. **immediate reaction — 即時反應；第一反應**

Practice 1

> My **immediate reaction** was to laugh.

我的**第一反應**是笑出來。

Practice 2

> Her **immediate reaction** was one of surprise.

她的**即時反應**是感到驚訝。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****immediate reaction = 事情發生後第一時間出現的反應****

4. **initial reaction — 最初反應**

Practice 1

> His **initial reaction** was negative.

他的**最初反應**比較負面。

Practice 2

> My **initial reaction** changed after I understood the reason.

了解原因後，我的**最初反應**改變了。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****initial reaction = 在有更多時間思考之前，最早出現的反應****

5. ****strong reaction — 強烈反應****

Practice 1

> The decision caused a ****strong reaction****.

這個決定引起了****強烈反應****。

Practice 2

> She had a ****strong emotional reaction**** to the photo.

她看到那張照片後有很****強烈的情緒反應****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****strong reaction = 情緒、行為或回應的程度非常明顯或強烈****

6. ****emotional reaction — 情緒反應****

Practice 1

> The album produced a very ****emotional reaction****.

那本相簿引起了很強的****情緒反應****。

Practice 2

> His ****emotional reaction**** was understandable.

他的****情緒反應****可以理解。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****emotional reaction = 由感情引起的明顯反應，例如開心、難過、感動、憤怒****

7. ****have a reaction — 有反應；出現反應****

Practice 1

> She **had a positive reaction** to the idea.

她對這個想法有**正面反應**。

Practice 2

> He **had no reaction** at all.

他完全**沒有反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

have a reaction = 對某件事表現出某種回應

8. **get a reaction** — 引起反應

Practice 1

> The joke finally **got a reaction** from the audience.

那個笑話終於**引起觀眾反應**。

Practice 2

> I showed her the photo to **get a reaction**.

我給她看那張照片，想看看會不會**引起反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get a reaction = 成功令某人作出某種回應

9. **public reaction** — 公眾反應

Practice 1

> The announcement caused a mixed **public reaction**.

這項公布引起了褒貶不一的**公眾反應**。

Practice 2

> The company monitored **public reaction** closely.

公司密切留意**公眾反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

public reaction = 大眾對某項事件、決定或消息的集體回應

10. **market reaction — 市場反應**

A business/finance sense.

Practice 1

> The **market reaction** was immediate.

市場反應非常迅速。

Practice 2

> Investors watched the **market reaction** to the announcement.

投資者留意市場對公布的**反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

market reaction = 金融市場或消費市場對消息、政策或事件作出的價格或行為變化

11. **reaction (身體 / 醫學反應) — 身體反應**

A separate branch.

Practice 1

> She had a bad **reaction** to the medicine.

她對那種藥出現了不良**反應**。

Practice 2

> Stop using the product if you develop a skin **reaction**.

如果皮膚出現**不良反應**，就停止使用產品。

MCQ-ready definition:

****reaction = 身體因藥物、食物、化學物質等而產生的生理變化****

12. ****allergic reaction — 過敏反應****

Practice 1

> He had an ****allergic reaction**** to peanuts.

他吃花生後出現****過敏反應****。

Practice 2

> The cream caused a mild ****allergic reaction****.

那款乳霜引起輕微****過敏反應****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****allergic reaction = 免疫系統對某種物質產生的過敏性身體反應****

13. ****adverse reaction — 不良反應****

Practice 1

> Some patients experience an ****adverse reaction****.

部分病人會出現****不良反應****。

Practice 2

> The drug was withdrawn after reports of serious ****adverse reactions****.

有報告指出出現嚴重****不良反應****後，該藥物被撤回。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****adverse reaction = 藥物、治療或物質引起的不希望出現的負面身體反應****

14. ****reaction (化學反應) — 化學反應****

A major scientific sense.

Practice 1

> Mixing the two substances caused a chemical **reaction**.

把兩種物質混合後產生了**化學反應**。

Practice 2

> The **reaction** released heat.

這個**反應**釋放了熱能。

MCQ-ready definition:

reaction = a chemical process in which substances change into different substances

中文：

物質經化學變化形成其他物質的過程

15. **chemical reaction — 化學反應**

Practice 1

> Rusting is a chemical **reaction**.

生鏽是一種**化學反應**。

Practice 2

> The experiment produced a visible chemical **reaction**.

這個實驗產生了肉眼可見的**化學反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chemical reaction = 化學物質互相作用並形成新物質的過程

16. **chain reaction — 連鎖反應**

Literal/scientific and figurative.

Practice 1

> One event started a **chain reaction**.

一件事引發了一連串**連鎖反應**。

Practice 2

> The failure caused a **chain reaction** across the system.

這次故障在整個系統中引發了**連鎖反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

chain reaction = 一個反應或事件觸發另一個，再接連引發更多反應或事件

17. **reaction time** — 反應時間

Practice 1

> Drivers need fast **reaction times**.

駕駛者需要很快的**反應時間**。

Practice 2

> Fatigue can slow your **reaction time**.

疲勞會令你的**反應速度變慢**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reaction time = 從刺激出現到身體或人作出反應之間所需的時間

18. **reaction** (反作用 ; 逆向回應) — 反作用 ; 反彈

A broader abstract sense.

Practice 1

> The change produced an unexpected **reaction**.

這項改變產生了意想不到的**反作用 / 反彈**。

Practice 2

> Strict rules sometimes create an opposite **reaction**.

太嚴格的規則有時會引起相反的**反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reaction = 某個行動或變化所引發的相反或回應性結果

19. **react to something — 對.....作出反應**

Verb sense.

Practice 1

> How did she **react to the gift**?

她對這份禮物有甚麼**反應**？

Practice 2

> He **reacted calmly** to the news.

他平靜地**回應**這個消息。

MCQ-ready definition:

react to X = 因 X 發生而表現出某種情緒、行為或身體變化

20. **react strongly / badly / positively — 強烈 / 不良 / 正面反應**

Practice 1

> She **reacted strongly** to the criticism.

她對批評**反應很強烈**。

Practice 2

> His skin **reacted badly** to the cream.

他的皮膚對乳霜有**不良反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

react + adverb = 以某種方式對刺激、事件或情況作出反應

21. **overreact** — 反應過度；反應過火

Practice 1

> I think you're **overreacting**.

我覺得你**反應過度**了。

Practice 2

> He **overreacted** to a small mistake.

他對一個小錯誤**反應過火**。

MCQ-ready definition:

overreact = 作出比情況實際需要更強烈的反應

22. **underreact** — 反應不足

Less common, but established.

Practice 1

> The company **underreacted** to the warning signs.

公司對警號**反應不足**。

Practice 2

> It's possible to **underreact** as well as overreact.

除了反應過度，也可能**反應不足**。

MCQ-ready definition:

underreact = 作出的反應比情況合理需要的程度更弱

23. **reactive** (容易反應的；反應性的) — 反應性的

Practice 1

> This metal is highly **reactive**.

這種金屬的**化學反應性很高**。

Practice 2

> The substance becomes more **reactive** when heated.

這種物質受熱後會變得更**活潑 / 容易反應**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reactive = likely to react easily, especially chemically

24. **reactive** (被動回應的 ; 遇事才反應的) — 被動應對的

A business/behavioural sense.

Practice 1

> The team was too **reactive** and rarely planned ahead.

團隊太過**被動應對**，很少預先規劃。

Practice 2

> We need a proactive rather than **reactive** approach.

我們需要主動，而不是**事後回應式**的方法。

MCQ-ready definition:

reactive = responding after events happen instead of planning or acting in advance

25. **reactivity** — 反應性 ; 活性

Practice 1

> Scientists measured the chemical **reactivity** of the material.

科學家量度這種材料的化學**反應性**。

Practice 2

> Stress can increase emotional **reactivity**.

壓力可以增加情緒**反應性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

reactivity = the tendency or degree to respond strongly to a stimulus, event, or substance

Important distinction 1: **reaction vs response**

These often overlap.

reaction

often more immediate, instinctive, emotional, or automatic.

response

can be more deliberate, considered, or formal.

> Her first reaction was surprise.

她第一反應是驚訝。

> Her formal response came the next day.

她第二天才作出正式回應。

In your passage, **reaction** is perfect because the mother's laughter, silence, and emotion were spontaneous.

Important distinction 2: **reaction vs reply**

reply

specifically answers words/messages/questions.

reaction

can be:

* facial expression

- * emotion
- * movement
- * behaviour
- * physical change

So:

> She smiled in reaction to the gift.

cannot naturally be replaced by **reply**.

Important distinction 3: **reaction vs emotion**

emotion

the feeling itself.

reaction

the overall response caused by something.

A reaction may include emotion, speech, expression, and behaviour.

In your passage:

- * laughter
- * silence
- * becoming emotional

together form the mother's **reaction**.

Important distinction 4: **reaction vs behaviour**

behaviour

how someone acts generally or in a situation.

reaction

specifically what happens **because of a trigger**.

A reaction always implies something happened first.

Important distinction 5: **react** vs **act**

act

do something.

react

do something because something else happened first.

> He acted quickly.

他迅速行動。

> He reacted quickly to the warning.

他迅速對警告作出反應。

Important distinction 6: **react to** vs **respond to**

Very close, but:

react to

often more spontaneous/emotional.

respond to

often more deliberate or communicative.

> react angrily

憤怒反應

> respond politely

禮貌回應

Not a rigid rule, but a useful tendency.

Important distinction 7: **reaction = emotional vs medical**

Emotional

> Her reaction was touching.

她的反應令人感動。

Medical

> She had a reaction to the medicine.

她對藥物出現不良反應。

Same noun, very different domain.

Important distinction 8: **reaction = medical vs allergic reaction**

reaction

general bodily response.

allergic reaction

specifically immune-system-related hypersensitivity.

Not every bad reaction is an allergy.

Important distinction 9: **reaction = human response vs chemical reaction**

Human

> reaction to a gift

對禮物的反應

Chemical

> reaction between two substances

兩種物質之間的化學反應

This is one of the strongest polysemy splits.

Important distinction 10: **chain reaction literal vs figurative**

Scientific

one reaction triggers another.

Figurative

one event causes a series of consequences.

> One cancellation started a chain reaction of delays.

一次取消引起一連串延誤。

Important distinction 11: **reaction time vs response time**

reaction time

often human/biological speed after a stimulus.

response time

broader:

- * customer service
- * computer systems
- * emergency services

> driver reaction time

駕駛者反應時間

> website response time

網站回應時間

Important distinction 12: **overreact vs be dramatic**

They overlap but are not identical.

****overreact****

reaction is stronger than warranted.

****be dramatic****

behaviour/expression is theatrical or exaggerated.

A person can overreact quietly; a person can be dramatic without being genuinely upset.

Important distinction 13: ****reactive vs responsive****

****reactive****

often waits until something happens, then responds.

****responsive****

responds readily and appropriately.

In management:

> reactive approach

事後應對

> responsive service

反應迅速、能配合需要的服務

Family-extension note

****Reaction**** has four major modern branches:

1. ****human emotional/behavioural response****

* reaction to a gift

* immediate reaction

* emotional reaction

2. **public/system response**

- * public reaction
- * market reaction

3. **physical/medical response**

- * reaction to medicine
- * allergic reaction

4. **scientific reaction**

- * chemical reaction
- * chain reaction

The verb family adds:

5. **react**

- * react to
- * react strongly

6. **degree of reaction**

- * overreact
- * underreact

7. **reactive / reactivity**

- * chemically reactive
- * reactive approach
- * emotional reactivity

The core semantic idea stays consistent:

something happens → something else responds

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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reaction	反應	response to trigger
reaction to X	對 X 的反應	triggered response

immediate reaction	即時 / 第一反應	first response	
initial reaction	最初反應	early response	
strong reaction	強烈反應	intense response	
emotional reaction	情緒反應	feeling-based	
have a reaction	出現反應	show response	
get a reaction	引起反應	provoke response	
public reaction	公眾反應	collective response	
market reaction	市場反應	economic response	
reaction (medical)	身體反應	physiological response	
allergic reaction	過敏反應	immune response	
adverse reaction	不良反應	harmful response	
chemical reaction	化學反應	substance transformation	
chain reaction	連鎖反應	one triggers another	
reaction time	反應時間	response speed	
react to X	對 X 作反應	verb	
react strongly/badly	強烈 / 不良反應	manner	
overreact	反應過度	too strong	
underreact	反應不足	too weak	
reactive (chemical)	反應性高的	reacts easily	
reactive (approach)	被動應對的	responds after event	
reactivity	反應性；活性	tendency to react	

For your original sentence

> That ****reaction**** told me I had hit the nail on the head.

Here:

****reaction = 媽媽看到相簿後自然流露出來的一整套情緒和行為回應****

That includes:

- * laughing at some pages,
- * becoming quiet at others,
- * getting emotional.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 她的這些****反應****讓我知道，這份禮物真的送對了。

The key nuance is that ****reaction**** here is broader than just ****emotion****: it includes what she ****felt, showed, and did**** after seeing the album.